

a place considered by the Greeks to be the center of the world. This woman was called the Pythia and a new woman would be chosen to fill the role upon her death. By the 8th century BCE, Pythias were recognized for their prophetic powers. According to mythology, the first Pythia was a young virgin, but after she was raped, only older, less desirable women were chosen. The Pythia did, however, dress in a young woman's clothes. People flocked from all over Greece to ask the Pythia questions. She sat atop a tripod and entered a trancelike state, giving answers and predictions that were often ambiguous. The Pythia filled one of the most powerful female roles in the Classical world and shaped history by guiding men on matters of politics, religion, and warfare.

**"THE MALE IS ... SUPERIOR  
AND THE FEMALE [IS]  
INFERIOR; ... ONE RULES,  
AND THE OTHER IS RULED."**

ARISTOTLE, *POLITICS*

▼ **Domestic scenes**

These scenes copying ancient Greek terra-cotta show wealthy women and their female servants undertaking a variety of domestic tasks, including gathering olives, spinning, and dressing.

